

Perspective Glasses Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 25-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	25-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	perspective-glasses

Big idea: Perspective can limit and enrich knowledge.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students see that the same event can be known differently by different knowers.

Student Prompt

Inspect Perspective Glasses Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Perspective Glasses Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Four role cards: scientist, artist, historian, and advertiser looking at one object. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Perspective Glasses Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A classroom photo interpreted through safety, beauty, efficiency, and fairness lenses. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Perspective Glasses Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A perspective switch where students must defend a reading they did not choose. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Perspective can limit and enrich knowledge.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Perspective Glasses Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Perspective Glasses Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Does perspective limit knowledge or enrich it?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how perspective can limit and enrich knowledge.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Does perspective limit knowledge or enrich it?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: Four role cards: scientist, artist, historian, and advertiser looking at one object.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Four role cards: scientist, artist, historian, and advertiser looking at one object.
- A classroom photo interpreted through safety, beauty, efficiency, and fairness lenses.
- A perspective switch where students must defend a reading they did not choose.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/perspective-glasses/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/perspective-glasses/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/perspective-glasses/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Assign groups different perspectives: student, teacher, parent, university admissions officer, AI company, another student.
2. Each group lists what they know, what they care about and what evidence they would request.
3. Groups present their interpretation.
4. The class separates factual disagreement from value disagreement.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Does perspective limit knowledge or enrich it?
- Are some perspectives more legitimate than others?
- Can objectivity include multiple perspectives?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...